

The 5-Part Watchman's Prompt

Stop getting mush out of AI. Give the order clearly the first time.

Most men get vague, generic answers out of AI because they put vague, generic prompts in. The fix is structure. A complete prompt has five parts — learn them once, and the same thirty-minute task starts taking eight, because you're not gambling on every prompt; you're giving an order a competent subordinate could actually execute.

1 • ROLE

Tell the AI who to be. "You are a CPA reviewing a small-business P&L," not "help me with my finances." A named role pulls sharper, more expert output.

2 • CONTEXT

Give it what it can't guess — your situation, the constraints you're under, what's already been tried. The AI is only as good as what you hand it.

3 • INTENT

Say the actual outcome you want. Not "thoughts on this email" but "rewrite this so it's shorter and lands the deadline without sounding harsh."

4 • CONSTRAINTS

Set the guardrails: length, tone, what to avoid, what's off-limits. This is where the watchman draws his lines — "no specifics about my family," "under 150 words."

5 • FORMAT

Name the shape of the answer: a table, three bullets, a draft email, an outline. You'll stop re-rolling the dice and start getting usable output the first time.

ALL FIVE, IN ONE PROMPT

“You are a seasoned men’s-ministry leader (role). I’m preparing a 10-minute talk for eight men on stewarding technology at home (context). I want an outline that opens with a story and ends with one concrete challenge (intent). Keep it under 250 words, plain language, no clichés, nothing about my own family (constraints). Give it to me as a bulleted outline with a one-line takeaway (format).”

This is one rep from **The Watchman’s Course** — the 12-week AI mission for Christian men who want to wield technology for God’s glory without losing themselves to it. If this helped, the full course is where it goes deep.

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